
Paper 3, Option 37.2:

Germany, 1871–1990: united, divided and reunited

Overview

This option comprises two parts: the *Aspects in breadth* focus on long-term changes and contextualise the *Aspects in depth*, which focus in detail on key episodes.

Together, the breadth and depth topics explore the ways in which Germany evolved as a new state in Europe undergoing dramatic changes of fortune, set within broader long-term social and economic developments (after 1945, these focus on West Germany). A dynamic empire ended in a brutal war and defeat; out of the ashes of imperial Germany, first a democratic republic and then an extraordinary dictatorship came into being, followed once again by democracy and finally a new unity in 1990.

Aspects in breadth: prosperity and social change, 1871–1990	
Themes	Content
1 Social change in Germany and West Germany	• Changes in class structure and prosperity, 1871–1990: the growth of the urban working class, the artisan tradition and its impact, the slow decline of the land-owning elite and the peasantry, the rise of the white collar workers (key developments: Bismarck's introduction of pensions and health insurance in the 1880s, social mobility after the Second World War). • The changing role of women, 1871–1990: roles in the family and the workplace in the nineteenth and twentieth centuries (key developments: the impacts of the First World War, Nazi policies, the Second World War and post-war opportunities).
2 Economic change in Germany and West Germany	• Strength in manufacturing and agriculture's slow decline, 1871–1990; the reasons for nineteenth-century industrial growth; change in the twentieth century (key developments: the slump in agricultural prices in the 1920s, mass unemployment from 1930 to 32, the post-war 'economic miracle'). • The role of government policies in economic change, 1871–1990 (key developments: the introduction of protection 1879, the building of a large navy from 1898 to 1914, the impact of Nazi policies, the impact of Marshall Aid, the impact of membership of the European Community and the Common Agricultural Policy post-1956).

Aspects in depth: different approaches to the problem of difference	
Key topics	Content
1 Ruling the Second Reich, 1871–79	- Impact of the new Germany's constitution: trying to reconcile unity and division; the federal government and the <i>Länder</i>. - The importance of the <i>Reichstag</i> and the parties: relationship with Bismarck; the impact of regional and social divisions. - Attempts to consolidate the new Germany: Bismarck's break with, the National Liberals; the <i>Kulturkampf</i>; the appeal to nationalism to achieve unity; the War in Sight crisis.
2 The birth of democratic Germany, 1917–19	- Strains of war, tensions and military dictatorship 1917; the roles of Hindenburg and Ludendorff; Erzberger's Peace Resolution, emergence of the Independent Socialist Party. - Constitutional reforms from above 1918; the role of Prince Max of Baden; disintegration, defeat and revolution, 1918–19; the roles of Ebert, Scheidemann and Rosa Luxemburg. - The attempt to achieve unity through democracy: the Weimar Republic; the importance of the Weimar Constitution including its salient features and their strengths and potential weaknesses for achieving freedom and stability.
3 A new Reich, 1933–35	<i>Gleichschaltung</i>, 1933–34: creating a totalitarian state; abolition of political parties and trade unions; the establishment of DAF; the 'coordination' of regional and local government; impact of the Night of the Long Knives. - Hitler's role as Führer, including his approach to government, decline of cabinet meetings, relations with the army; the extent of his power by 1935. - The nature of the new Nazi state: the relationship of state and party; attempts to create a <i>Volksgemeinschaft</i>; racial policy, including the significance of the Nuremberg Laws.
4 Establishing and ruling the new Federal Republic, 1949–60	- The creation of the FRG and the impact of the new Constitution: the attempt to reconcile difference and liberty. - The importance of Adenauer and the CDU in shaping the new Federal Republic. Changes in the nature of the SPD and their significance for the shaping of the Federal Republic. - The process and significance of de-Nazification and 'coming to terms with the past' in the 1950s.
5 Reunification: recreating a united Germany.	- Reasons for the flood of refugees from the GDR in 1989. - The revolution in the GDR 1989, and its impact on the FRG; the significance of Kohl's Ten Point Plan.